

ACTIVITY 6 — FACILITATOR GUIDE**Project Charter**

TYPE	DURATION	MAPS TO	TOPIC
Workshop	75 minutes	LO1	2 - Start the Project

Purpose of this activity

By the end of this activity learners will be able to write a complete project charter that authorises the project and names the PM's authority.

What learners produce

project charter, approach decision, assumption log — submitted to artifacts/.

Materials required

- Learner Worksheet (one per learner)
- Checklist (one per group)
- Laptop with internet access for the live problem-solving tools
- The course slides for the framework and worked example

Set-up

Groups of 3 to 4. Distribute one worksheet per learner and one checklist per group; each group needs one laptop for the calculations.

Scenario / briefing material

Contoso Learning Pte Ltd is a training provider with 14,000 active learners. Its course registration portal is 9 years old. Registration takes a median of 11 minutes and 34% of attempts are abandoned. Learner communications consume 24 staff-hours per week across 3 administrators. 62% of learner traffic is mobile, against a portal that is not responsive. Legacy consent screens do not meet current PDPA requirements. The project modernises course registration and learner communications.

How to run it — step by step

#	Instruction to learners	Facilitator note
1	Assemble the charter inputs. Everything in a charter comes from somewhere. Confirm you have each input before drafting.	Check the arithmetic on one group's numbers before moving on — a wrong sign propagates into every later step.
2	Write the charter header and purpose	If a group finishes early, ask what changes at twice the scale or half the budget.
3	State measurable success criteria. Deliverables are what you build. Success criteria are how anyone knows it worked. Keep them separate and make every criterion numeric.	Ask what the number would have to be before the decision flips. That is the exam's favourite question.
4	Define scope boundaries, including exclusions. The exclusions section prevents more disputes than the inclusions section.	The trace is the learning, not the artifact. Ask a group to walk one line end to end aloud.
5	Record high-level requirements, milestones and budget	Make a group state the UNITS and the base

		date. Most errors here are unit errors, not maths errors.
6	Name the project manager's authority. This section is what makes the charter operationally useful, and it is heavily tested. Be specific.	Ask what the number would have to be before the decision flips. That is the exam's favourite question.
7	Document the development approach decision. Create artifacts/06-approach-decision.md. The ECO enabler is "Recommend a development approach (predictive, adaptive/agile, or hybrid)". A recommendation needs criteria, not taste.	Check the arithmetic on one group's numbers before moving on — a wrong sign propagates into every later step.
8	Build the assumption and constraint log. Create artifacts/06-assumption-log.md. Assumptions are things you have taken as true without proof - each one is a latent risk, which is why Lab 14 revisits this log.	Make a group state the UNITS and the base date. Most errors here are unit errors, not maths errors.
9	Answer the exam-style scenarios	Ask what the number would have to be before the decision flips. That is the exam's favourite question.

Suggested timing

Minutes	Phase
8 min	Brief the scenario, confirm the inputs and assign roles
28 min	Work the first half of the steps individually, then pool as a group
28 min	Complete the remaining steps and finalise the deliverable
11 min	Group share-back, facilitator debrief and exam-style linkage

Total: 75 minutes

Discussion & decision prompts

1. Write a complete project charter that authorises the project and names the PM's authority — how did your group decide, and what would change that decision?
2. Set measurable success criteria distinct from deliverables — how did your group decide, and what would change that decision?
3. Justify the hybrid development approach with a documented tailoring decision rather than a preference — how did your group decide, and what would change that decision?
4. Every success criterion has a numeric baseline and a numeric target. "Improved registration" is not a success criterion — can every member of your group defend it?
5. Where would project charter have saved you time or money on a real project you have worked on?

What good looks like

- Every success criterion has a numeric baseline and a numeric target. "Improved registration" is not a success criterion.
- Your charter has a sponsor signature block, and you can explain why the PM's signature alone would not authorise anything.
- Every exclusion has a rationale traceable to an earlier lab's evidence.
- Your milestone list contains milestones only - if it contains activities with durations, that belongs in Lab 12.
- Your PM authority section states specific figures for procurement and change approval, consistent with the Lab 03 thresholds.
- Your approach decision names both what is predictive and what is adaptive, and explains the interface between them. "Hybrid" alone is not a decision.

- Every assumption has a validation date earlier than the point at which being wrong would be unrecoverable. Check A-05 in particular.
- You can state the difference between contingency reserve and management reserve, and who controls each.